

Creating Clear Instructions

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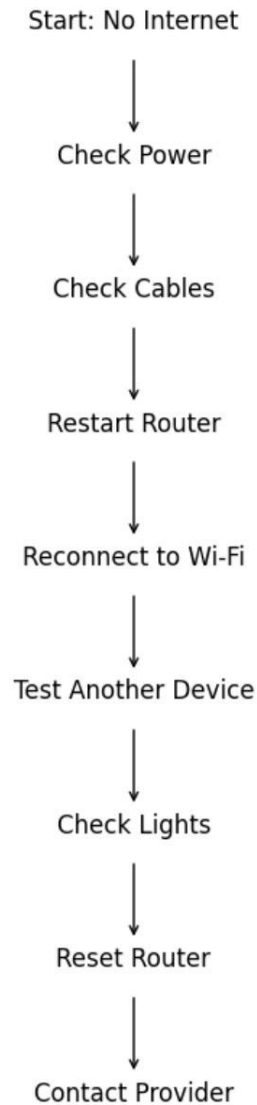
The common technical task that I chose to write a set of instructions for is resetting a Wi-Fi router. Please see the steps below:

1. Check the power by ensuring the router power cord is plugged in and that the power light is on. If not, try a different outlet.
2. Ensure the Ethernet cable from the modem is securely plugged into the router's Internet or WAN port.
3. Restart the router by unplugging it for 30 seconds, plug it back in and wait for all lights to turn on normally.
4. Check the Wi-Fi connection by making sure your device successfully connected back to your network, (if applicable, enter the Wi-Fi password).
5. If your device will not connect, test a different device by trying to connect to the Wi-Fi network to see if the issue persists.
6. If the issue persists, check the router lights. Look for any red blinking lights and review the router manual if needed.
7. Reset the router one last time by holding the power button for 30 seconds to restore to factory settings.
8. If the problem still persists, please contact your internet provider to confirm if there is an outage in service.

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Flow Chart

Resetting the Router - Flowchart



The feedback that I received from my man after he read through my instructions was that I needed to be more specific, especially in the first step about checking the power. I initially wrote, “Ensure the router is plugged up and powered on,” but he mentioned that this could be

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confusing because it does not explain how to confirm that it is actually on. Based on that feedback, I revised the step to say to check that the power light is on and to try a different outlet if it is not, which makes it much clearer for someone who may not be familiar with routers.

Another issue he pointed out was that some steps assumed the user already had basic knowledge, like knowing what a WAN port is or how to recognize router lights. I added some detail in those steps to try and guide the user without making the instructions too long. I also clarified the reset step by explaining that it restores factory settings, so the user understands what will happen.

Testing my instructions helped me realize that what seems obvious to me might not be obvious to someone else. It showed me how important it is to be clear, specific, and to think from the user's perspective. I learned that strong technical writing should avoid assumptions, use simple language, and include enough detail to prevent confusion without overwhelming the reader. Overall, the feedback helped me improve the clarity of my instructions.

References

Kolin, P.C. (2022). *Successful Writing at Work (12th ed.)*. Cengage.